GROOVEBOX

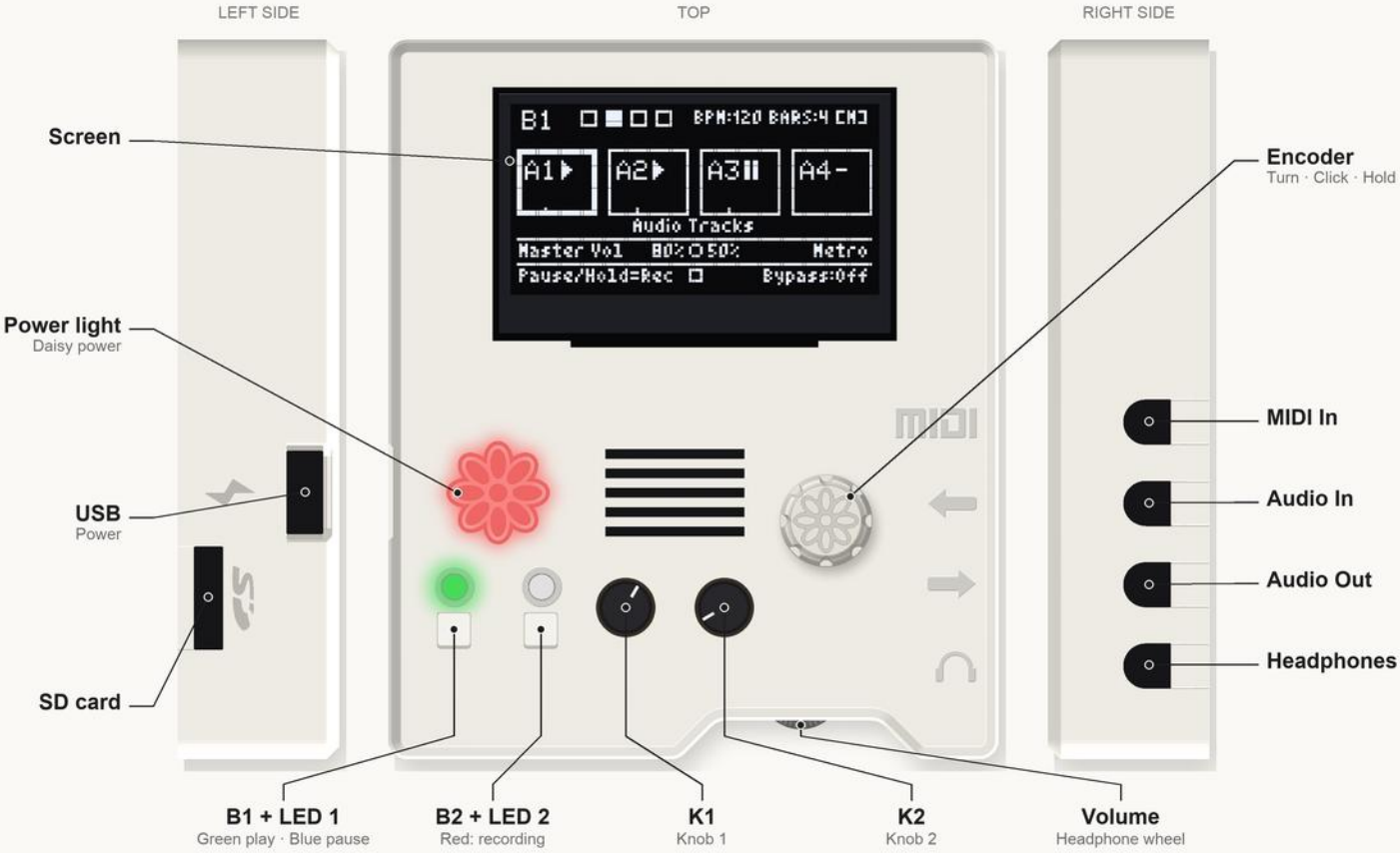
Quick Start



Eight engines · four-track looper · eight-track MIDI sequencer

1 Meet the Groovebox

Everything you touch, plug in and look at.



THE ENCODER

Turn
move between pages

Click
go in, or back out

Hold
Home, or Global settings

Triple-click
all notes off

KNOBS & BUTTONS

K1 · K2
set the two values on the screen's upper row

B1 · B2
do what the lower row says

Volume wheel
headphone level

THE LIGHTS

LED 1
green playing, blue paused, flashing blue counting in

LED 2
red while recording

Daisy
power is on

2 Get set up

A card, power, and something to listen on.

A Prepare the SD card

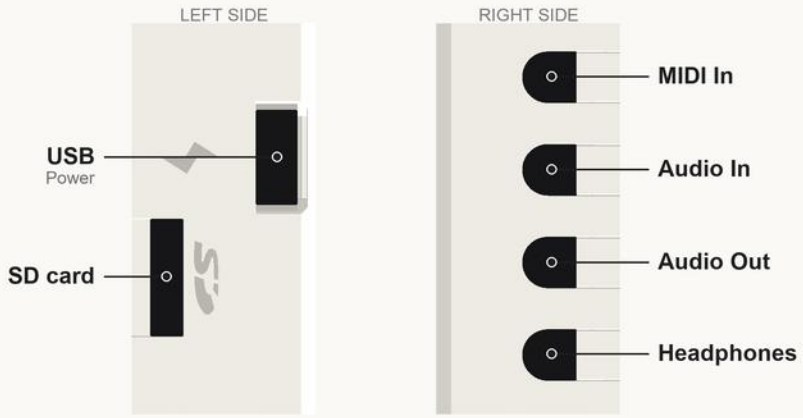
On your computer, unzip sdcard-template.zip onto a FAT32 micro SD card, and copy main.bin onto it too. Both come with each release.

The template holds the demo song, starter sounds and the folders the Groovebox saves into. A Pod that has never run this firmware needs a one-time bootloader install first: see the manual.

B Put the card in, then plug in

Slide the card into the left side, under the SD mark. Plug headphones into the headphone jack, or Audio Out into speakers. A MIDI keyboard goes into MIDI In. Power comes in over USB, by the lightning mark.

Always switch off before taking the card out or putting it in.



C Switch on

With main.bin on the card, the Groovebox installs it by itself the first time, then starts. The PZD GROOVEBOX logo shows for a moment, then the Home screen. The daisy lights to show the power is on.

Home is where you always come back to: hold the encoder from anywhere.

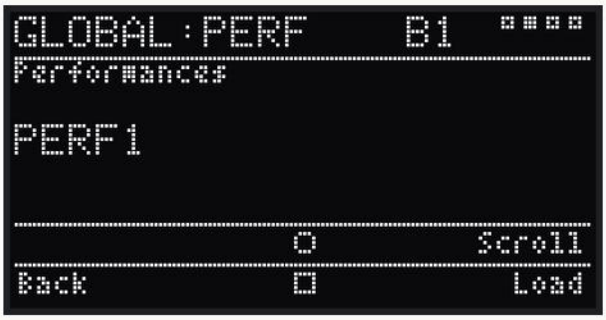


3 Hear the demo, record a loop

Ten minutes from switch-on to your own sound.

A Load the demo

Hold the encoder to open Global, then turn it to Global:Perf. Tap B2 (Load), turn K2 to PERF1 and tap B2 again.



B Play the song

Hold the encoder to go Home, then turn it past the tracks to the Song page. Tap B1 to play, and again to stop.



C Record your first loop

On Home, turn to A1 and hold B1. The click counts in one bar, with LED 1 flashing blue. Play into Audio In: LED 2 is red while it records, and it stops by itself at the end of the loop.

Tap B1 to pause or play the loop. Hold B1 again to record more on top.

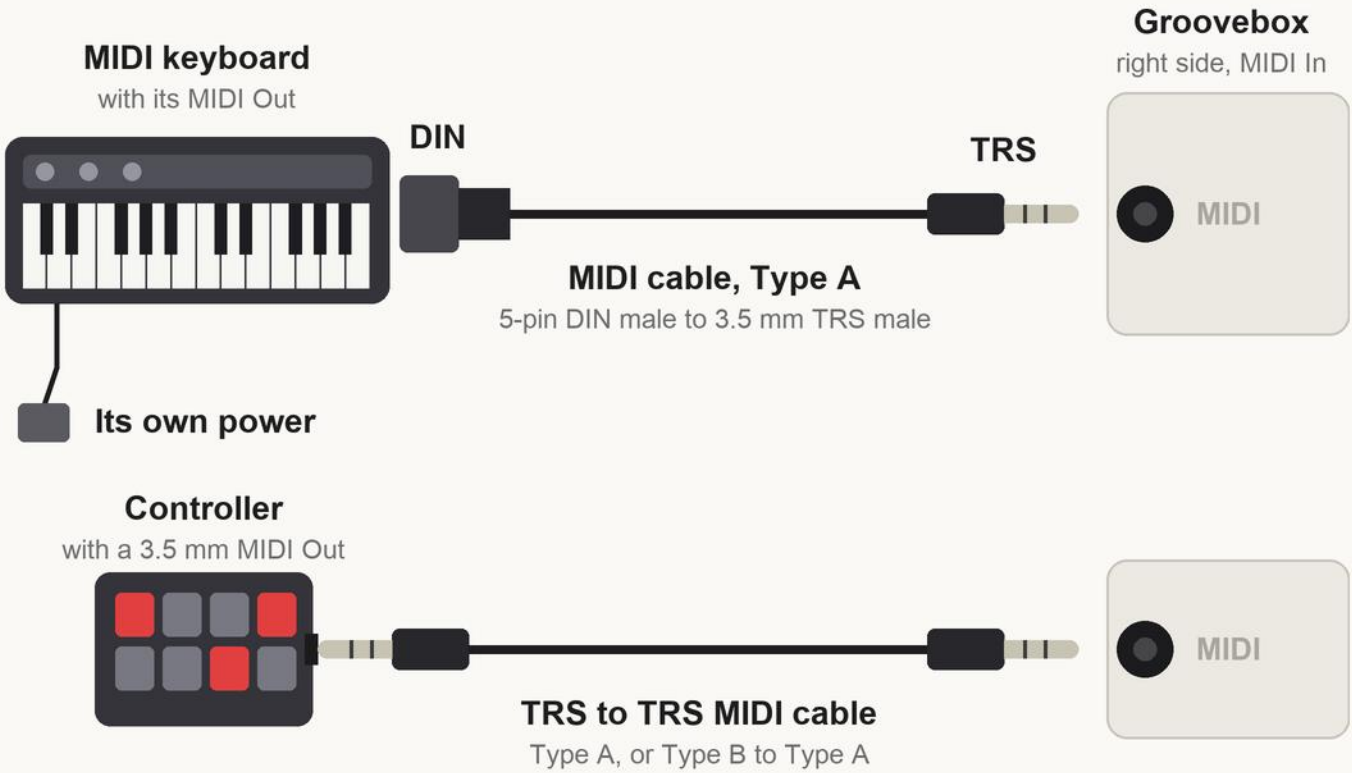


4 Connect a MIDI keyboard

Any keyboard or controller with a MIDI Out: 5-pin or 3.5 mm.

A Plug it in

One cable from the keyboard's MIDI Out to MIDI In: 5-pin DIN male to 3.5 mm TRS male, or TRS to TRS if the keyboard has a 3.5 mm MIDI Out. The keyboard needs its own power: the Groovebox doesn't power it.



MIDI In is Type A, the MIDI standard. If a controller's TRS output is Type B (some Arturia and Novation gear), use a Type B to Type A cable. MIDI comes in through MIDI In only, not over USB.

B Set the channel

Set the keyboard to send on MIDI channel 1: every engine listens there to start with, except the drum sampler on 10. To give engines their own channels, use Global:MIDI.

5 Choose an engine and a sound

Eight engines, each with its own factory sounds.

A Switch an engine on

Every engine starts switched off. Hold the encoder to open Global, turn to an engine (Global:SSaw is the Supersaw) and tap B1. The page shows ENABLED. Now play.



B Pick a sound

Click the encoder to open the engine, and turn to its Preset page. Tap B2, turn K2 through the sounds, and tap B2 to load one. Keep playing while you browse.



C Make it yours

Turn back through the engine's pages to change its sound: K1 and K2 set the two values on each page. Save it on the User page: tap B1, then hold B2.

THE ENGINES

Dexed Global:DXD-A · DXD-B	DX7-style FM: electric pianos, bells, basses, brass. Two of them, to layer or split the keyboard.
Ensemble Global:Ensmbl	A string machine: lush strings and pads, with its own chorus.
Organ Global:Organ	A drawbar tonewheel organ, with percussion and key click.
Supersaw Global:SSaw	Seven detuned saws: trance leads, plucks, big chords.
Grains Global:Grains	Granular textures and pads from audio you capture or import.
Sample Sound Global:SMPVO	One captured or imported sound, played across the keyboard.
Sample Drum Global:SMPDR	Drum kits and breaks on pads. Listens on channel 10.

6 Make a song

Tracks, then scenes, then the song.

A Record a MIDI track

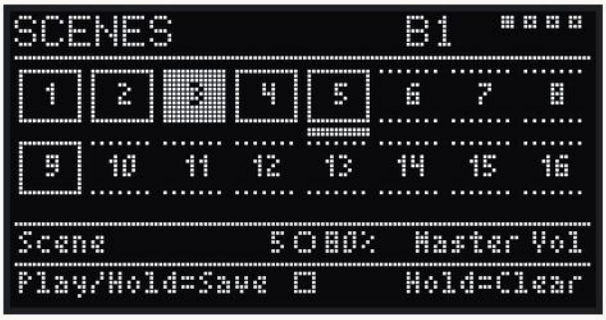
On Home, turn past A4 to M1. Click in and pick its engine with K1, then click back out. Hold B1, play a pass after the count-in, and it loops.

MIDI tracks work like audio tracks: tap B1 to pause, hold to add more.



B Save scenes

Get the tracks playing the way the first part should sound, then go to the Scenes page and hold B1: that's scene 1. Change things and save scene 2, and so on. Tap B1 to launch one.



C Build the song

On the Song page, hold B1 and launch scenes on the Scenes page: each becomes a step, for as long as it played. Or click in and give each step a scene (K1) and its repeats (K2). Tap B1 to hear it.



D Export it

On Global:Export, turn K1 to Song and tap B1. The song is written to the card as a WAV file, ready to play on a computer.

7 Save your work

Two kinds of save: the whole song, or just the sounds.

A Save a Performance

A Performance is everything: the audio tracks, the MIDI tracks with their patterns, the scenes, the song and every engine's sound. On Global:Perf tap B1, turn K1 to Overwrite or Save New, and hold B2.



Saving only reaches the card when you do it: save before you switch off.

B Save a Snapshot

A Snapshot keeps every engine's sound at once, and which engines are on, so you can bring the same set of sounds into a new song. On Global:Snap it saves the same way: tap B1, pick with K1, hold B2.

C Load them again

On Global:Perf or Global:Snap, tap B2 to open the list, turn K2, and tap B2 to load.

WHERE NEXT

The User Manual covers every page in detail: the sequencer's patterns, chains and piano roll, the arpeggiator, every engine, the mixer, effects and the card.

SOMETHING NOT RIGHT?

A note won't stop	Triple-click the encoder: all notes off, on every engine.
No sound	Is the engine ENABLED on its Global page? Is the keyboard on channel 1? Check Master Vol (K1 on Home) and the headphone wheel.
Screen is dark	The screen saver: touch any control to wake it. That first touch does nothing else.
"No SD card"	Switch off, push the card fully in, and switch on again.
The keyboard does nothing	Check the cable is Type A, and that it goes into MIDI In.
New firmware didn't install	A Pod new to this firmware needs the bootloader once: see the manual.